



Executive Full Investment Committee Report

Startup: AgriNova Malawi	Founder: Dr. Chimwemwe Phiri
Sector / Geo: AgTech / Supply Chain Malawi / SADC	Stage: Seed Date: August 17, 2026

EXECUTIVE INVESTMENT DECISION SNAPSHOT			
INVEST	Trust Score: 88/100	Conviction: 89% (HIGH)	Reliability: A
TOP INVESTMENT DRIVERS • AgriNova Malawi is an IC-ready AgTech platform delivering solar-powered cold chain and digital off-take solutions to 14,000+ smallholder farmers. The company demonstrates \$1.2M ARR, 310% YoY revenue growth, and grade-A evidence integrity. • INVEST — Allocate \$350K Seed check. AgriNova is the lead candidate in the OSTX AgTech cohort.		TOP FLAGGED RISKS • [MEDIUM] Corridor FX Exposure: Local currency (MWK) devaluation risk requires structured USD export off-take hedging.	
RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION: Finalize term sheet for \$350K Seed allocation			

Founder	Startup	Market	Trust	Risk↓	Overall Score
90	87	89	88	22	86

1. Executive Summary & Thesis

AgriNova Malawi is an IC-ready AgTech platform delivering solar-powered cold chain and digital off-take solutions to 14,000+ smallholder farmers. The company demonstrates \$1.2M ARR, 310% YoY revenue growth, and grade-A evidence integrity.

2. Founder & Capability Assessment

Dr. Chimwemwe Phiri brings 12+ years of senior agronomic and operational experience. Outstanding digital footprint and high trust score across regional agricultural networks.

3. Startup Product & Operational Assessment

Validated B2B2C business model with high farmer retention rates, unit-positive margin structure, and clear competitive moat in solar cold storage.

4. Market Dynamics & Competition

Addressing a \$4.2B post-harvest loss market in Southern Africa, with strong tailwinds from climate-adaptation financing.

5. Risk Factors & Mitigations

Low regulatory risk in Malawi; primary risk is MWK currency volatility, mitigated by planned regional export corridors.

6. Final Investment Recommendation

INVEST — Allocate \$350K Seed check. AgriNova is the lead candidate in the OSTX AgTech cohort.

7. Actionable Next Steps

- Finalize term sheet for \$350K Seed allocation

- 2. Complete technical audit of solar cold-storage telemetry hardware
- 3. Structure FX buffer mechanism for cross-border revenues

Evidence Reliability & Contradiction Report

Rating: A (92/100) · Depth: Comprehensive · Consistency: Clean
Sources reviewed: 12 · Claims extracted: 14 · High-authority sources: 5

Red Flag Alerts & Mitigations

[MEDIUM] Corridor FX Exposure

Local currency (MWK) devaluation risk requires structured USD export off-take hedging.
Mitigation: Structure FX buffer via USD export contracts before Series A.

Twin Syndicate Consensus & Investor Voting

Final Consensus Recommendation: Invest | Consensus Score: 88/100 | Dissent Score: 12/100

• Pan-African VC Partner (Pan-African VC Partner, Kulima Ventures) — Invest

Reasoning: Strong unit economics and resilient farmer off-take contracts.

• Development Finance Officer (Development Finance Officer, Impact Fund) — Invest

Reasoning: Outstanding climate resilience impact and gender-inclusive cooperative model.

• Diaspora Angel Investor (Diaspora Angel Investor, Syndicate Angels) — Invest

Reasoning: Operator credibility and deep local trust networks in Malawi.

• Corporate VC Investor (Corporate VC Investor, AgriCorp Ventures) — Co-Invest

Reasoning: Strategic distribution synergies for regional fertilizer and seed supply chains.

• Global Tier-1 VC Partner (Global Tier-1 VC Partner, Global Capital) — Invest

Reasoning: High capital efficiency with clear Series A momentum.

Source Attribution & OSINT Intelligence

- [1] Malawi AgTech Sector Report 2025 · <https://agtech.mw/reports/2025-agrinova>
- [2] Dr. Chimwemwe Phiri — Leadership Profile · <https://linkedin.com/in/cphiri-agrinova>
- [3] USAID Feed the Future Partner Feature · <https://feedthefuture.gov/partners/agrinova-malawi>
- [4] Malawi Ministry of Agriculture Cooperative Registry · <https://agriculture.gov.mw/registries/agrinova>
- [5] Airtel Money Malawi Partner Brief · <https://airtel.mw/partners/agrinova-payouts>